END OF TERM 1 · 2026–2027

Term 1 Revision & Practice Booklet

Stage 9 · B2.2 programme · Reading challenge up to C1.1

Study notes · Vocabulary & grammar activities · Reading · Writing · 100-mark mock · Answer key

Name: ..... **Class:** ..... **Date:** .....

How to use this booklet
Read the notes first. Try each activity without looking at the answers, then check yourself with the answer key at the back. Finally, complete the mock paper on your own. All practice texts and questions are original revision material, not official exam questions.

Contents

1. Exam map and themes
2. Vocabulary: word list and activities
3. Grammar: notes and practice
4. Mixed grammar practice
5. Reading skills
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7. Mock paper (100 marks)
8. Final checklist
9. Answer key

1 Exam map and themes

Section	Format	Marks
Part 1: Vocabulary	One text (180 words ±10%), 5 gaps, A/B/C options	10
Part 2: Grammar	One expository text (180 words ±10%), 5 gaps, A/B/C	10
Part 3A: Reading	Argumentative text (330–350 words ±10%), 8 A/B/C questions	24
Part 3B: Reading	Expository text (330–350 words ±10%), 8 A/B/C questions	16
Writing 1.1	Two-viewpoint text (200 words ±10%); write 4–5 sentences in your own words	15
Writing 1.2	Comparative essay; respond to three prompts; at least 220 words in paragraphs	25
TOTAL	Reading & language 60 · Writing 40	**100**

Themes to prepare

Vocabulary: Pushing Boundaries · Rise to the Challenge! | Grammar: My roof is alive! (green roofs) | Reading 3A: Personality — Nature or Nurture? | Reading 3B: Megacities and Small Towns | Writing: Smart Homes OR Comparing Places

The writing function is **comparing and contrasting**. The exam runs on SwiftAssess.

2 Vocabulary

Remember: a *distraction* takes your attention away; an *interruption* actually stops the activity. A *voyage* is the journey; a *destination* is the place you reach. *Kinaesthetic* and *auditory* describe types of task, not types of learner.

Word list: Pushing Boundaries

Word	Meaning	Example
privacy	Keeping personal information and activities protected.	*Smart devices may put our privacy at risk.*
freedom	The ability or right to make your own choices.	*Working remotely gives people greater freedom.*
automation	Using machines or software to perform tasks automatically.	*Automation controls the lights when nobody is home.*
cost-effective	Giving good results for the money spent.	*LED lighting is a cost-effective way to save energy.*
interruptions	Events that stop an activity for a short time.	*Repeated interruptions made the task take longer.*
distractions	Things that draw your attention away from your task.	*I silence my phone to avoid distractions.*
voyage	A long journey, especially by sea or through space.	*The spacecraft began a voyage to Mars.*

destination	The place to which someone is travelling.	*The final destination was a research station.*
heritable	Able to be passed from parents to offspring through genes.	*Some physical characteristics are heritable.*
significant	Important or large enough to have an effect.	*Training made a significant difference.*
consequence	A result or effect of an action or situation.	*One consequence of poor sleep is reduced attention.*
database	An organised electronic collection of information.	*Researchers store the results in a database.*

Word list: Rise to the Challenge!

Word	Meaning	Example
megacity	A city with a population of more than ten million.	*A megacity needs extensive public transport.*
urbanisation	The growth of towns and cities as more people live there.	*Urbanisation increases demand for housing.*
congestion	Overcrowding, especially too much traffic.	*Congestion delays buses during rush hour.*
pollution	Harmful substances or waste in the environment.	*Cleaner transport can reduce air pollution.*
infrastructure	Basic systems such as roads, power, water and transport.	*The city is investing in its infrastructure.*
innovative	Introducing new ideas or methods.	*Engineers developed an innovative cooling system.*
kinaesthetic	Connected with movement and physical activity.	*A kinaesthetic activity may involve building a model.*
auditory	Connected with hearing or sound.	*An auditory task involves listening.*
insulation	Material that reduces the transfer of heat or sound.	*Roof insulation helps keep the building cool.*
drainage	A system or process that removes excess water.	*Good drainage prevents water from collecting.*
biodiversity	The variety of living organisms in an area.	*Native plants can support biodiversity.*
vegetation	Plants growing in a particular area.	*Vegetation provides shade and habitats.*

Word list: Green-roof terms

Word	Meaning	Example
living roof	A roof covered with plants; also called a green roof.	*The school added a living roof to its library.*
rooftop	The outer top surface of a building.	*Solar panels were fitted on the rooftop.*
absorb	To take in a liquid, heat or another substance.	*The soil absorbs rainwater.*

urban heat	Heat in built-up places, often increased by heat-storing surfaces.	*Trees help to reduce urban heat.*
habitat	The natural home of a plant or animal.	*The roof garden became a habitat for bees.*
sustainable	Able to continue while limiting harm to resources and the environment.	*Rainwater harvesting is a sustainable practice.*

Useful combinations: traffic congestion · air pollution · urban infrastructure · significant consequence · protect privacy · improve drainage · support biodiversity

Matching 1: words and meanings

Write the letter of the correct meaning next to each word.

1. **privacy** ____
2. **freedom** ____
3. **automation** ____
4. **cost-effective** ____
5. **interruptions** ____
6. **distractions** ____
7. **voyage** ____
8. **destination** ____
9. **heritable** ____
10. **significant** ____
11. **consequence** ____
12. **database** ____

a An organised electronic collection of information.

b Important or large enough to have an effect.

c The place to which someone is travelling.

d Events that stop an activity for a short time.

e A long journey, especially by sea or through space.

f Able to be passed from parents to offspring through genes.

g Giving good results for the money spent.

h Things that draw your attention away from your task.

i The ability or right to make your own choices.

j Using machines or software to perform tasks automatically.

k A result or effect of an action or situation.

l Keeping personal information and activities protected.

Matching 2: words and meanings

Write the letter of the correct meaning next to each word.

1. **megacity** ____
2. **urbanisation** ____
3. **congestion** ____
4. **pollution** ____
5. **infrastructure** ____
6. **innovative** ____
7. **kinaesthetic** ____
8. **auditory** ____
9. **insulation** ____
10. **drainage** ____
11. **biodiversity** ____
12. **vegetation** ____

a Plants growing in a particular area.

b Connected with movement and physical activity.

c A system or process that removes excess water.

d The growth of towns and cities as more people live there.

e The variety of living organisms in an area.

f A city with a population of more than ten million.

g Basic systems such as roads, power, water and transport.

h Introducing new ideas or methods.

i Harmful substances or waste in the environment.

j Overcrowding, especially too much traffic.

k Material that reduces the transfer of heat or sound.

l Connected with hearing or sound.

Sentence gap-fill

Choose the word that best completes each sentence.

1. The school introduced an ___ app that lets parents follow homework online.
A privacy **B** cost-effective **C** innovative

2. Factories use ___ so that robots can complete repetitive tasks quickly.
A automation **B** consequence **C** vegetation

3. Rapid ___ has created new suburbs around the capital.
A urbanisation **B** kinaesthetic **C** database

4. The exam was full of ___: the fire alarm rang twice and the lights went off.
A interruptions **B** automation **C** voyage

5. Listening to a podcast and answering questions is an ___ activity.
A voyage **B** auditory **C** kinaesthetic

6. Poor ___ caused the streets to flood after the storm.
A megacity **B** drainage **C** kinaesthetic

7. The library keeps a record of every book in an online ___.
A automation **B** vegetation **C** database

8. Building a bridge from paper is a ___ task because learners use their hands.
A significant **B** kinaesthetic **C** voyage

9. After the rains, the hillside was covered with green ___.
A vegetation **B** megacity **C** freedom

10. Thick roof ___ keeps the house cool in summer.
A insulation **B** megacity **C** innovative

11. The explorers prepared for a six-month ___ across the Pacific Ocean.
A congestion **B** distractions **C** voyage

12. There has been a ___ increase in the number of people buying electric cars.
A significant **B** vegetation **C** kinaesthetic

13. Waste from factories has increased water ___ in the river.
A privacy **B** pollution **C** significant

14. Online courses give students the ___ to study at their own pace.
A auditory **B** freedom **C** insulation

15. Road works caused heavy ___ on the main highway this morning.
A automation **B** congestion **C** cost-effective

16. Coral reefs are famous for their rich ___: thousands of species live there.
A biodiversity **B** interruptions **C** auditory

17. Eye colour is a ___ characteristic that children receive from their parents.
A auditory **B** heritable **C** consequence

18. Reliable ___, such as roads, power and water, attracts new businesses.
A cost-effective **B** infrastructure **C** significant

19. In winter, Dubai is a popular tourist ___.
A drainage **B** destination **C** megacity

20. With more than thirty million residents, Greater Tokyo is a ___.
A innovative **B** heritable **C** megacity

21. Many people worry that smart speakers record their conversations and threaten their ___.
A megacity **B** privacy **C** biodiversity

22. Phone notifications are common ___ when students are revising.
A megacity **B** distractions **C** consequence

23. Missing the deadline had a serious ___: the team lost the project.
A consequence **B** drainage **C** significant

24. A reusable water bottle is a ___ alternative to buying plastic bottles every day.
A cost-effective **B** infrastructure **C** privacy

Choose the best word

1. The spacecraft began a long ___ to another planet.
A destination **B** voyage **C** database

2. The roof has a ___ system to remove extra rainwater.
A drainage **B** privacy **C** freedom

3. A characteristic passed through genes is ___.
A innovative **B** auditory **C** heritable

4. Too many cars cause traffic ___.
A congestion **B** vegetation **C** insulation

5. This solution saves money and works well; it is ___.
A kinaesthetic **B** cost-effective **C** heritable

6. The variety of species in the park is its ___.
A automation **B** biodiversity **C** destination

Collocations

Which word goes naturally with the words given?

1. traffic ___
A congestion **B** database **C** biodiversity

2. air ___
A pollution **B** freedom **C** voyage

3. urban ___
A auditory **B** heritable **C** infrastructure

4. protect your ___
A destination **B** privacy **C** drainage

5. support ___
A biodiversity **B** megacity **C** interruptions

6. improve ___
A heritable **B** drainage **C** significant

7. a ___ consequence
A kinaesthetic **B** auditory **C** significant

8. avoid ___
A urbanisation **B** distractions **C** vegetation

9. a space ___
A insulation **B** database **C** voyage

10. a holiday ___
A destination **B** automation **C** pollution

11. roof ___
A insulation **B** freedom **C** consequence

12. home ___
A automation **B** megacity **C** heritable

13. rapid ___
A auditory **B** urbanisation **C** privacy

14. an online ___
A vegetation **B** drainage **C** database

Confusing pairs

Choose the correct word.

1. The phone call was an ___: I had to stop writing completely.
A interruption **B** distraction

2. Music with lyrics can be a ___ while you are reading.
A interruption **B** distraction

3. The ___ took three weeks because of storms at sea.
A voyage **B** destination

4. After three weeks at sea, they finally reached their ___.
A voyage **B** destination

5. Teenagers often want more ___ to choose their own activities.
A freedom **B** privacy

6. Never share your password, so you can protect your ___.
A freedom **B** privacy

7. Exhaust fumes from cars increase air ___.
A congestion **B** pollution

8. At 7:30 a.m. there are so many cars that ___ stops all movement.
A congestion **B** pollution

9. The desert has very little ___, only a few small bushes.
A vegetation **B** biodiversity

10. The forest has high ___: over 200 species of birds live there.
A vegetation **B** biodiversity

11. Good ___ in the walls keeps the room quiet and cool.
A insulation **B** drainage

12. Blocked pipes caused poor ___, and water collected on the roof.
A insulation **B** drainage

13. Listening to a recording and answering questions is an ___ task.
A auditory **B** kinaesthetic

14. Building a model bridge with your hands is a ___ task.
A auditory **B** kinaesthetic

15. Lagos is a ___ with a population of over fifteen million.
A megacity **B** urbanisation

16. ___ means more people moving into towns and cities.
A Megacity **B** Urbanisation

Word forms

Choose the correct form of the word.

1. Factories that ___ rivers should pay heavy fines.
A pollute **B** pollution **C** polluted

2. The company plans to ___ its customer service with chatbots.
A automation **B** automate **C** automatic

3. The area has become highly ___ over the last thirty years.
A urbanisation **B** urbanise **C** urbanised

4. She is famous for her ___ designs.
A innovative **B** innovation **C** innovate

5. The new phone was a real ___ when it was released.
A innovative **B** innovation **C** innovate

6. Scientists explained the ___ of the results.
A significant **B** significance **C** significantly

7. Prices have risen ___ this year.
A significant **B** significance **C** significantly

8. The main road is always ___ at 8 a.m.
A congestion **B** congested **C** congest

9. The house is well ___, so it stays cool.
A insulated **B** insulation **C** insulate

10. Sandy soil ___ quickly after rain.
A drainage **B** drains **C** drain

11. Could we speak ___? It's a personal matter.
A privacy **B** private **C** privately

12. Children ___ some characteristics from their parents.
A inherit **B** heritable **C** heredity

13. The bus broke down. ___, I was late for school.
A Consequence **B** Consequently **C** Consequent

14. Everyone should be ___ to express their opinions.
A freedom **B** free **C** freely

Spelling puzzle

Read the meaning and write the word. The first letter and the number of letters are given.

1. Overcrowding, especially too much traffic.
c _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (10 letters) _____

2. Introducing new ideas or methods.
i _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (10 letters) _____

3. Connected with movement and physical activity.
k _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (12 letters) _____

4. The variety of living organisms in an area.
b _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (12 letters) _____

5. The place to which someone is travelling.
d _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (11 letters) _____

6. Plants growing in a particular area.
v _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (10 letters) _____

7. A city with a population of more than ten million.
m _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (8 letters) _____

8. Harmful substances or waste in the environment.
p _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (9 letters) _____

9. The growth of towns and cities as more people live there.
u _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (12 letters) _____

10. An organised electronic collection of information.
d _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (8 letters) _____

11. Using machines or software to perform tasks automatically.
a _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (10 letters) _____

12. Able to be passed from parents to offspring through genes.
h _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (9 letters) _____

Exam-style text 1: A voyage to Mars

Read the text and choose A, B or C for each gap.

A voyage to the red planet

Space agencies are planning a long **(1)** _____ to Mars, a journey that could take around seven months in each direction. Before the astronauts leave, scientists will store information about their health in a secure **(2)** _____, so that doctors on Earth can monitor them throughout the mission.

Life on board will not be easy. The crew will have very little **(3)** _____ because they will share a small living space for many months. Alarms and system checks may also cause frequent **(4)** _____ during their work and sleep. To reduce stress, engineers are designing spacecraft in which **(5)** _____ controls routine tasks, such as adjusting the temperature and recycling water. Supporters say the mission could teach us how humans adapt to extreme conditions, while critics question its enormous cost.

Gap 1 **A** destination **B** voyage **C** database

Gap 2 **A** database **B** consequence **C** freedom

Gap 3 **A** pollution **B** vegetation **C** privacy

Gap 4 **A** interruptions **B** destinations **C** biodiversity

Gap 5 **A** congestion **B** automation **C** drainage

Exam-style text 2: Growing cities

Read the text and choose A, B or C for each gap.

Growing cities

By 2050, around two-thirds of the world's population is expected to live in urban areas. This rapid **(1)** _____ is changing the way people live, travel and work. In a **(2)** _____ such as Cairo or Mumbai, millions of people travel every day, and traffic **(3)** _____ can turn a ten-kilometre journey into a two-hour trip.

Cities are responding with **(4)** _____ ideas, from driverless buses to apps that show the quickest route in real time. However, new roads, power lines and water pipes are expensive, and governments must decide which **(5)** _____ projects deserve investment first. Planners agree that cities which ignore these challenges will face serious problems in the future.

Gap 1 **A** insulation **B** urbanisation **C** auditory

Gap 2 **A** megacity **B** database **C** voyage

Gap 3 **A** vegetation **B** privacy **C** congestion

Gap 4 **A** heritable **B** innovative **C** auditory

Gap 5 **A** infrastructure **B** biodiversity **C** freedom

Exam-style text 3: Learning by doing

Read the text and choose A, B or C for each gap.

Learning by doing

Teachers often use a variety of activities to help students remember new information. In an **(1)** _____ task, learners listen to a recording or discuss ideas in pairs. In a **(2)** _____ task, they move around the room or build a model with their hands.

Research suggests that teaching every student in only one preferred 'style' brings no **(3)** _____ benefit; variety is what really helps. Some abilities may be partly **(4)** _____, passed down from parents, but practice and good teaching still make a huge difference. One positive **(5)** _____ of offering varied activities is that students who struggle with one method get another chance to succeed.

Gap 1 **A** infrastructure **B** auditory **C** insulation

Gap 2 **A** kinaesthetic **B** heritable **C** megacity

Gap 3 **A** auditory **B** significant **C** heritable

Gap 4 **A** cost-effective **B** innovative **C** heritable

Gap 5 **A** consequence **B** destination **C** pollution

Use the words: write your own

1. Explain the difference between **voyage** and **destination**.

2. Write a sentence with **privacy** and **automation**.

3. Write a sentence with **insulation** and **urban heat**.

4. Write a sentence with **habitat** and **vegetation**.

5. Write a sentence with **megacity** and **congestion**.

6. Write a sentence with **significant** and **consequence**.

3 Grammar: notes and practice

G.5.1 **Zero conditional** General facts, rules and repeated results

Form: *If/When* + present simple, present simple.

- If plants receive enough water, they grow.
- If rain falls on a green roof, the soil absorbs some of it.
- When water collects, the drainage system carries it away.

Tips: The clauses can change order: *Plants grow if they receive enough water.* Use a comma after the if-clause when it comes first. Don't use *will* for these general facts.

Practice: Zero conditional

Choose A, B or C.

1. If the soil becomes dry, the sensor ___ a signal.
A sends **B** sent **C** will sending

2. When rain ___, the tank collects water.
A fall **B** falls **C** is fall

3. Plants grow if they ___ enough light.
A received **B** receive **C** receives

4. If you heat ice, it ___.
A melts **B** melted **C** will melted

5. When the temperature ___ below zero, water freezes.
A drop **B** drops **C** dropped

6. If plants ___ sunlight, they cannot produce food.
A don't get **B** doesn't get **C** didn't got

7. Metal expands if you ___ it.
A heat **B** heats **C** heated

8. If people ___ too little, they feel tired.
A sleeps **B** sleep **C** slept

9. When a roof has no insulation, the rooms ___ hot.
A become **B** became **C** becomes

10. Which sentence is correct?
A If it rains, the streets get wet.
B If it rains, the streets will got wet.
C If it rain, the streets get wet.

11. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?
A If water boils it turns into steam.
B If water boils, it turns into steam.
C If water boils it, turns into steam.

G.1.2 **Comparative adjectives** Comparing two things

Short adjectives: + *-er than* (cool → cooler, hot → hotter, busy → busier). **Longer adjectives:** *more* + adjective + *than* (efficient → more efficient). **Irregular:** good → better, bad → worse.

- A planted roof is cooler than a bare roof.
- This design is more sustainable than the old one.
- *Less expensive than* = a lower degree; *as effective as* = equal.

Never write *more cooler* or *gooder*.

Practice: Comparative adjectives

Choose A, B or C.

1. A shaded roof is ___ than an exposed roof.
A cool **B** coolest **C** cooler

2. Native planting is ___ than frequent replanting.
A more sustainable **B** sustainabler **C** most sustainable

3. This design is ___ than the previous one.
A gooder **B** best **C** better

4. The metro is ___ than the bus.
A fast **B** faster **C** more fast

5. Life in a megacity is ___ than life in a village.
A more expensive **B** expensiver **C** most expensive

6. My new phone is ___ than my old one: it keeps crashing.
A worse **B** badder **C** more bad

7. Traffic today is ___ than yesterday.
A heavy **B** heavier **C** heavyer

8. Small towns are often ___ than big cities.
A quiet **B** quieter **C** more quieter

9. Solar panels are ___ expensive than they were ten years ago.
A less **B** fewer **C** least

10. Online classes can be as effective ___ face-to-face classes.
A than **B** as **C** like

11. Summer in the UAE is ___ than winter.
A hoter **B** hotter **C** more hot

G.2.9 Adverbs of quantity and degree How much? How strongly?

Use **much, far, a lot, slightly, considerably** before a comparative: *much cooler, far more effective, slightly more expensive*.

Use **very** with the base adjective only: *very cool* ✔ *very cooler* ✘.

- **much / less** + uncountable: much water, less water
- **many / fewer** + countable plural: many plants, fewer plants
- **too much** water · **enough** plants

Practice: Adverbs of quantity and degree

Choose A, B or C.

1. A living roof can be ___ cooler than concrete.
A very **B** much **C** many

2. This system uses ___ water than the old one.
A fewer **B** many **C** less

3. There are ___ weeds after regular maintenance.
A less **B** much **C** fewer

4. The train is ___ faster than the bus.
A very **B** much **C** many

5. Small towns have ___ hospitals than megacities.
A less **B** fewer **C** much

6. There isn't ___ space on the roof for a garden.
A enough **B** many **C** fewer

7. This model is ___ more expensive: only five dirhams more.
A slightly **B** far **C** very

8. We have ___ water: the tank is overflowing.
A too much **B** too many **C** enough of

9. The new building uses ___ less energy than the old one.
A considerably **B** very **C** many

10. ___ people now work from home at least once a week.
A Much **B** Many **C** Less

11. The city is ___ more crowded than it was in 2000.
A far **B** very **C** too

G.10.1 Present simple passive When the process matters more than the doer

Form: *am / is / are* + past participle.

- Active: Workers install a drainage layer. → Passive: A drainage layer **is installed**.
- Active: Plants absorb water. → Passive: Water **is absorbed** by plants.
- Negative: The roof **is not watered** daily.
- Question: **Is** the roof **inspected** regularly?

Check two things: the subject controls *is/are*, and you need the past participle (built, grown, chosen, made).

Practice: Present simple passive

Choose A, B or C.

1. The plants ___ by a sensor-controlled system.
A watered **B** are watered **C** is watered

2. Rainwater ___ in a tank.
A is stored **B** are stored **C** stores

3. The material ___ for its low weight.
A is choose **B** is chosen **C** are chosen

4. English ___ in many countries.
A speaks **B** is spoken **C** are spoken

5. The solar panels ___ every month.
A is cleaned **B** are cleaned **C** clean

6. Coffee ___ by farmers in Brazil.
A grows **B** is grown **C** are grown

7. The information ___ in a secure database.
A is stored **B** are store **C** stores

8. Which is the passive form of “Engineers design the system”?
A The system is designed by engineers.
B The system designed engineers.
C The system is design by engineers.

9. The roof ___ every day; once a week is enough.
A is not watered **B** not is watered **C** does not watered

10. ___ the plants checked regularly?
A Is **B** Are **C** Do

11. Most smartphones ___ in Asia.
A make **B** are made **C** is made

G.17.4 Indirect questions Polite questions with statement word order

Start with *Could you tell me...? / Do you know...? / Can you explain...?* Then use **statement word order**.

- Direct: Where **does the water go**? → Could you tell me where **the water goes**?
- Direct: **Is the roof** safe? → Do you know **if/whether the roof is** safe?

Remove do/does/did and put the tense on the main verb. Use **if/whether** for yes/no questions.

Practice: Indirect questions

Choose A, B or C.

1. Could you explain where ___?
A does water collect **B** water collects **C** collects water

2. Do you know ___ the roof needs repairs?
A if **B** what **C** where

3. Could you tell me how much ___?
A does it cost **B** it costs **C** costs it

4. Can you tell me where the station ___?
A is **B** is it **C** does

5. Do you know what time the museum ___?
A does open **B** opens **C** open

6. I wonder ___ the bus is late.
A if **B** what **C** does

7. Could you tell me how long the journey ___?
A takes **B** does take **C** take

8. Do you know ___ they live?
A where **B** where do **C** do where

9. “Why did the flight leave late?” → Could you tell me why ___?
A did the flight leave late **B** the flight left late **C** the flight did leave late

10. “Is the library open?” → Do you know ___?
A is the library open **B** if the library is open **C** if is the library open

11. “How much does the ticket cost?” → Can you tell me how much ___?
A the ticket costs **B** does the ticket cost **C** costs the ticket

G.2.5 Adverbial linkers Addition, contrast and result

Addition	Contrast	Result
moreover, furthermore, in addition	however, nevertheless	therefore, consequently, as a result

The installation is expensive. **However,** it can reduce cooling costs.
The roof stores water**; therefore,** runoff is reduced.

Choose the relationship first, then the word. Use a full stop or semicolon before the linker. Don't join two complete sentences with only a comma and *however*.

Practice: Adverbial linkers

Choose A, B or C.

1. It is costly. ___, it offers long-term savings.
A Therefore **B** Finally **C** However

2. The soil holds water. ___, less water reaches the street immediately.
A Consequently **B** However **C** First

3. Megacities offer many jobs. ___, housing is very expensive.
A However **B** Moreover **C** Therefore

4. Small towns are quiet. ___, they are often safer for children.
A Nevertheless **B** Furthermore **C** However

5. The main road was blocked. ___, we arrived late.
A As a result **B** In addition **C** However

6. The course was very difficult. ___, she passed with high marks.
A Nevertheless **B** Therefore **C** Moreover

7. Public transport reduces congestion. ___, it saves passengers money.
A In addition **B** However **C** Nevertheless

8. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?
A The bus is cheap, however it is slow.
B The bus is cheap. However, it is slow.
C The bus is cheap however, it is slow.

9. Which linker shows a result?
A moreover **B** therefore **C** nevertheless

10. Which linker adds a similar idea?
A furthermore **B** however **C** consequently

G.2.2 Sequencing adverbs First, next, then, finally

First / Firstly = the beginning · **Next / Then / Afterwards** = the following stage · **Finally** = the last stage.

First, engineers inspect the roof. Next, they install protective layers. Finally, they add plants.

Sequencing shows order, not a reason or a contrast.

Practice: Sequencing adverbs

Choose A, B or C.

1. First, inspect the roof. ___, add the protective layer.
A Because **B** Next **C** However

2. ___, remove the old soil. Next, add the drainage layer.
A First **B** Finally **C** However

3. First, check the roof. ___, install the waterproof layer.
A Then **B** Firstly **C** Because

4. Next, spread the soil. ___, plant the seeds and water them.
A Finally **B** First **C** Therefore

5. Which word shows the LAST stage?

A next **B** afterwards **C** finally

6. Which word does NOT show order?

A then **B** however **C** afterwards

7. I finished my homework. ___, I watched a film.

A Afterwards **B** Firstly **C** Moreover

4 Mixed grammar practice

Spot the correct sentence

Only one sentence in each group is correct.

1. Choose the correct sentence.

A The roof is much cooler now.

B The roof is more cooler now.

C The roof is very cooler now.

2. Choose the correct sentence.

A Could you tell me where he lives?

B Could you tell me where does he live?

C Could you tell me where lives he?

3. Choose the correct sentence.

A The plants is watered daily.

B The plants are watered daily.

C The plants are water daily.

4. Choose the correct sentence.

A If you mix red and white, you got pink.

B If you mix red and white, you get pink.

C If you will mix red and white, you get pink.

5. Choose the correct sentence.

A There are fewer cars on the road today.

B There are much cars on the road today.

C There are less cars on the road today.

6. Choose the correct sentence.

A It is expensive however it saves money.

B It is expensive, however it saves money.

C It is expensive. However, it saves money.

7. Choose the correct sentence.

A This plan is gooder than that one.

B This plan is better than that one.

C This plan is more better than that one.

8. Choose the correct sentence.

A Do you know is the shop open?

B Do you know if the shop is open?

C Do you know if is the shop open?

9. Choose the correct sentence.

A The windows is cleaned every week.
B The windows cleaned every week.
C The windows are cleaned every week.

10. Choose the correct sentence.

A City life is stressfuller than town life.
B City life is more stressful than town life.
C City life is most stressful than town life.

11. Choose the correct sentence.

A When water reaches 100°C, it boils.
B When water reaches 100°C, it will boiling.
C When water reach 100°C, it boils.

12. Choose the correct sentence.

A Then, we plan the design. However, we build it. Finally, we test it.
B Finally, we plan the design. Then, we build it. Firstly, we test it.
C Firstly, we plan the design. Then, we build it. Finally, we test it.

Name the linker

*Write **A** (addition), **C** (contrast), **R** (result) or **S** (sequence).*

1. **moreover** ____	2. **however** ____	3. **therefore** ____	4. **first** ____
5. **nevertheless** ____	6. **consequently** ____	7. **in addition** ____	8. **finally** ____
9. **as a result** ____	10. **furthermore** ____	11. **next** ____	12. **afterwards** ____

Put the steps in order

Number the sentences 1–5 in the correct order.

A. How a living roof is installed

- [ ] First, an engineer checks that the roof can support the extra weight.
- [ ] Next, a waterproof layer is installed to protect the building.
- [ ] Then, a drainage layer is added so that excess water can escape.
- [ ] After that, the growing material is spread across the roof.
- [ ] Finally, the plants are placed and watered.

B. How to write a comparative essay

- [ ] After that, develop each comparison in a separate paragraph.
- [ ] Next, plan two comparison points with reasons and examples.
- [ ] Finally, check your verbs, spelling and word count.
- [ ] First, read all three prompts and decide on your position.
- [ ] Then, write an introduction that names both options and gives your view.

Rewrite the sentence

Passive **1.** Workers check the roof every month.

Passive **2.** Gardeners water the plants twice a week.

Passive **3.** Engineers choose a light material for the roof.

Passive **4.** The tank stores rainwater.

Indirect question **5.** Where does the rainwater go? → Could you tell me …

Indirect question **6.** Is the roof strong enough? → Do you know …

Indirect question **7.** How much does a living roof cost? → Can you explain …

Indirect question **8.** When did they install the panels? → Do you know …

Zero conditional **9.** Plants get enough sunlight. They grow quickly. (If …)

Comparative **10.** A bare roof is hot. A living roof is not as hot. (… cooler than …)

Exam-style text 1: Cool roofs

Read the text and choose A, B or C for each gap.

Cool roofs

In many hot cities, dark roofs and roads absorb heat during the day. If a surface **(1)** _____ dark, it absorbs more sunlight and becomes very hot. One simple solution is the ‘cool roof’, which **(2)** _____ with a light-coloured coating that reflects sunlight back into the sky.

On a summer afternoon, a cool roof can be **(3)** _____ cooler than a traditional black roof. **(4)** _____, residents may use their air conditioners less, which saves both money and energy. Many homeowners ask, “Can you tell me how much the coating **(5)** _____?” The answer depends on the size of the roof, but the price is often lower than people expect.

Gap 1 **A** is **B** are **C** will be

Gap 2 **A** is painted **B** are painted **C** paints

Gap 3 **A** very **B** much **C** many

Gap 4 **A** As a result **B** However **C** First

Gap 5 **A** costs **B** does cost **C** cost

Exam-style text 2: Collecting rainwater

Read the text and choose A, B or C for each gap.

Collecting rainwater

Rainwater harvesting is a simple way to save water at home. **(1)** _____, rain is collected from the roof through gutters and pipes. Then the water **(2)** _____ in a large tank, usually next to the house or underground.

> If the tank **(3)** _____ full, the extra water flows out through an overflow pipe. Collected rainwater is not normally used for drinking, but it is ideal for watering gardens and washing cars, and it is **(4)** _____ expensive than tap water. People who are interested often ask whether the system **(5)** _____ a lot of maintenance. In fact, a quick check of the filters every few months is usually enough.

Gap 1 **A** First **B** However **C** Therefore

Gap 2 **A** is stored **B** are stored **C** stores

Gap 3 **A** becomes **B** become **C** will became

Gap 4 **A** less **B** fewer **C** least

Gap 5 **A** needs **B** does need **C** need

5 Reading skills

Task	What to do	Trap to avoid
Specific information	Scan for a name, number, example or condition, then check the sentence around it.	Choosing a familiar word that doesn't match the detail.
Details	Match every part of the option with the text; expect paraphrases.	An answer that is only partly true.
Main points	Identify the central claim of a paragraph or argument.	An interesting example that is too narrow.
Inference	Combine clues from the text with careful reasoning.	Using your personal opinions as evidence.
Overall meaning	Read the introduction and conclusion, then check the whole text.	A title that covers only one paragraph.
Tone / attitude	Notice evaluative words, qualifications and the balance of evidence.	Calling a balanced text angry or enthusiastic.
Connections	Explain how two ideas, examples or perspectives relate.	Assuming similar vocabulary means the same argument.

Routine: Skim → read the question → locate evidence → eliminate unsupported options → check the complete answer.

Reading 3A: Nature or nurture?

Nature = inherited characteristics and biological influences. **Nurture** = experience, relationships, education and surroundings. A balanced argument may claim the two *interact*. Heritable does not mean fixed.
Expected questions: 1 specific information · 4 detail · 1 main point · 1 inference · 1 overall meaning.

Reading 3B: Megacities and small towns

Track trade-offs: jobs, services, transport, housing, social networks, pollution, costs and access. Words like *may*, *depends* and *unevenly* signal a qualified position.
Expected questions: 3 detail · 2 inference · 1 tone · 1 connections · 1 overall meaning. This passage is set at C1.1.

Signal words for tone and inference

1. A writer says urban benefits are “distributed **unevenly**”. This suggests…

A not everyone gains equally
B everyone gains the same
C there are no benefits

2. “In principle, this allows residents to reach more opportunities. **In practice, however**…” The writer is about to…

A give more support for the idea
B show a gap between theory and reality
C change the topic completely

3. Words like *may, can, tends to, depends on* usually show a ___ position.

A qualified, careful
B angry, emotional
C certain, absolute

4. A text weighs benefits and limitations and uses careful language. The best tone description is…

A nostalgic and dismissive
B measured and analytical
C enthusiastic and excited

5. “A heritable tendency is not an instruction that must be followed.” We can infer that the writer believes…

A genes decide everything
B people can change
C inheritance is not real

6. Which option is most likely to be WRONG in an inference question?

A One that uses always, never or guarantees
B One that uses may
C One supported by two clues in the text

7. “**Conversely**, poorly planned urban development can remove vegetation.” *Conversely* introduces…

A an example
B the opposite case
C a conclusion

8. An option names one example from paragraph 2 only. For an *overall meaning* question it is probably…

A too narrow
B the best answer
C too general

6 Writing workshop

Task 1.1: Summary in 4–5 sentences (15 marks)

Identify the main claim and reasons in each viewpoint. Say what they share and how they differ. Paraphrase; don't copy whole phrases. Keep your own opinion out unless the question asks for it.

Five-sentence plan: (1) Introduce the shared issue. (2) Viewpoint A + main reason. (3) Viewpoint B + main reason. (4) An important similarity. (5) The central contrast.

Task 1.2: Comparative essay (25 marks)

At least **220 words** in paragraphs, answering all three prompts. A useful practice target is 240–280 words.

- **Introduction:** name both options; give a clear central position.
- **Body 1:** compare the same feature in both options.
- **Body 2:** compare another feature and explain its effects.
- **Body 3:** justify your preference with reasons and a realistic example.
- **Conclusion:** bring the comparison together and confirm your judgement.

Language bank

Similarity	both, similarly, in the same way, likewise
Contrast	whereas, while, however, in contrast, unlike, on the other hand
Reasons	because, since, one reason is that, this is due to
Examples	for example, for instance, such as
Qualification	may, can, tends to, depends on, in some cases
Judgement	on balance, in my view, overall, I would argue that

Develop your comparisons. Basic: *Cities have buses. Towns are quiet.* → Developed: *Large cities often offer frequent buses, whereas small towns may have limited services. This can make city life more practical for students who do not drive, even though crowded journeys can be tiring.*

Paraphrase practice

Choose the best paraphrase of each original sentence.

1. Original: *Housing in large cities is often very expensive.*

A Big cities never have cheap houses.
B Homes in big cities frequently cost a lot.
C Housing in large cities is often very expensive indeed.

2. Original: *Small towns usually have stronger community ties.*

A Small towns usually have stronger community ties.
B Everyone in a small town is friends.
C People in smaller places often know and support each other more.

3. Original: *Public transport can reduce the need to own a car.*

A Owning a car is the need of public transport.
B With good buses and trains, people may not need a car.
C Public transport always replaces cars.

4. Original: *Critics worry that smart devices collect personal data.*

A Critics worry that smart devices collect personal data.
B Smart devices are illegal.
C Some people are concerned that connected technology may gather private information.

5. Original: *Specialist medical care may be limited in rural areas.*

A People in the countryside may find it harder to get expert treatment.
B Specialist medical care may be limited in rural areas, they say.
C Rural areas have no doctors.

6. Original: *Automated devices reduce unnecessary electricity use.*

A Electricity is unnecessary in automated homes.
B Automated devices reduce unnecessary electricity use.
C Smart systems can help households avoid wasting power.

Comparison linkers in context

1. ___ cities offer more schools, small towns offer shorter journeys.
A Whereas **B** Therefore **C** Similarly

2. ___ settings can provide a good education for children.
A Both **B** Unlike **C** However

3. ___ city flats, town houses often have gardens.
A Unlike **B** Similarly **C** Because

4. Cities have many hospitals. ___, small towns usually have a local clinic.
A Similarly **B** Therefore **C** For example

5. Small towns are calm. ___, specialist services may be far away.
A On the other hand **B** As a result **C** Similarly

6. ___, a connected small town is the best choice for my family.
A On balance **B** For instance **C** Unlike

7. Many families choose cities ___ there are more job opportunities.
A because **B** whereas **C** although

8. ___ housing is expensive, many families still prefer the city.
A Although **B** Because **C** Similarly

Theme: Smart homes

Point	Smart home	Conventional home
Convenience	Automatic lighting, remote control, alerts	Manual control; familiar routines
Costs	Installation and repair costs; potential energy savings	Lower technology costs; savings depend on habits
Privacy	Connected systems may collect household data	Fewer connected devices can reduce data exposure
Reliability	May depend on connectivity, updates or electricity	Manual features may be easier to use during faults
Accessibility	Voice controls may support independence	Physical switches can be simpler for some users

Source text: two viewpoints

> Supporters of smart homes argue that connected technology makes daily life more convenient and efficient. Sensors can switch off lights in empty rooms, while automated systems adjust cooling according to household routines. Residents can check a security alert when they are away, and people with limited mobility may find voice controls particularly helpful. Although installation requires investment, supporters believe that suitable devices can reduce unnecessary energy use over time. They also say that users can choose only the features they need, rather than buying a

complete system. From this perspective, thoughtful automation gives residents more control over their homes.

Critics prefer homes that depend less on connected devices. They point out that household information may be collected by companies, making privacy a serious concern. Repairs, subscriptions and updates can also increase costs after installation. A network failure may prevent residents from using some functions, while complicated controls can frustrate people who prefer simple switches. Critics accept that technology can be helpful, but argue that benefits depend on reliable support and clear choices about data. They therefore recommend keeping manual alternatives and assessing each device carefully, instead of assuming that a more connected home is always a better home.

1.1 Compare and contrast the two viewpoints. Summarise the main ideas in your own words in 4–5 sentences.

1.2 Compare a highly automated home with a mainly conventional home. Discuss convenience and running costs; explain which type you prefer and why; support your choice with examples. Write at least 220 words in paragraphs.

Plan and write your answers on paper.

Theme: Comparing places

Compare the same criteria. Don't write one list about a city and another about a town. Choose a point such as transport, compare both places, explain why the difference matters, then link it to your preference. Your judgement can be conditional: the best place for a university student may differ from the best place for a remote worker.

Criterion	Megacity	Small town
Education & employment	Wider range of institutions and jobs	Fewer local options; remote work may help
Transport & access	Extensive networks, but congestion and crowding	Short local journeys; limited public transport
Environment	Heat and pollution may be challenges	More open space, but car dependence may remain
Community	Diverse networks; anonymity is possible	Closer relationships; privacy may feel limited
Affordability	High housing demand can increase prices	Housing may cost less; travel costs can offset savings

Prepare your position

My preferred place: _____
Reason 1 and example: _____
Reason 2 and example: _____
One disadvantage I acknowledge: _____

Your turn

Write a comparative paragraph about access to education. Include one similarity or contrast linker, a reason and an example.

7 Mock paper (100 marks)

Part 1 Vocabulary	Part 2 Grammar	Reading 3A	Reading 3B	Writing	Total
/10	/10	/24	/16	/40	/100

Part 1: Vocabulary (5 × 2 = 10 marks)

Read the text and choose A, B or C for each gap.

A school research team is designing a neighbourhood for the future. Its first priority is reducing traffic **(1)** _____, because long queues make journeys slower and less predictable. The students propose better public transport and safe walking routes rather than simply building wider roads. They also suggest collecting information in a shared **(2)** _____ so that planners can compare travel patterns before choosing a solution. However, they insist that residents should understand how their personal information is protected.

The second part of the project concerns buildings. Students recommend adding **(3)** _____ to suitable rooftops because plants can provide shade and create small habitats. They argue that careful planning can support **(4)** _____ by providing homes for different living organisms, rather than planting a single species everywhere. The team knows that new systems must be affordable as well as attractive. For this reason, it will compare installation and maintenance costs to identify the most **(5)** _____ option. Their final proposal will explain both the advantages and the practical limits of each design, using evidence instead of relying only on impressive pictures.

Gap 1 **A** freedom **B** congestion **C** destination

Gap 2 **A** database **B** voyage **C** consequence

Gap 3 **A** interruptions **B** privacy **C** vegetation

Gap 4 **A** automation **B** biodiversity **C** pollution

Gap 5 **A** heritable **B** auditory **C** cost-effective

Part 2: Grammar (5 × 2 = 10 marks)

Read the text and choose A, B or C for each gap.

A living roof is a system in which plants grow above a protective surface. First, the structure **(1)** _____ by qualified workers to ensure that it can support the additional weight. A waterproof layer and suitable drainage are then installed. The aim is to protect the building while allowing excess water to leave safely.

If rain **(2)** _____ on the roof, the growing material absorbs some of the water. This can slow the movement of runoff towards street drains. On hot days, a planted surface may be **(3)** _____ than an uncovered concrete surface, although performance depends on local conditions and maintenance. These benefits do not mean that every building is suitable. Owners should ask an engineer whether their roof can carry the load.

Residents often ask, “Could you explain how the drainage system **(4)** _____?” Understanding this process helps them recognise problems early. Regular checks are necessary because blocked outlets may cause water to collect. The initial cost can be high. **(5)** _____, a well-designed system

may offer environmental benefits for many years, particularly when plants are chosen carefully and maintenance is planned from the beginning.

Gap 1 **A** is checked **B** are checked **C** checks

Gap 2 **A** will fall **B** falls **C** fall

Gap 3 **A** coolest **B** more cooler **C** much cooler

Gap 4 **A** does work **B** works **C** work

Gap 5 **A** However **B** Therefore **C** Finally

Reading 3A (8 × 3 = 24 marks)

Nature and nurture: a false choice?

[1] Why do people respond differently to the same challenge? One student enjoys speaking to an unfamiliar audience, while another would rather prepare a written report. It is tempting to explain such differences entirely through genes or entirely through experience. However, this either-or approach creates a misleading picture of personality. A stronger explanation recognises that inherited tendencies and the environment influence each other throughout life.

[2] Supporters of biological explanations point to similarities between relatives, including twins who grow up in different households. Such patterns suggest that some personality differences have a heritable component. Yet a heritable tendency is not an instruction that must be followed. A person who initially avoids unfamiliar situations may become more confident through repeated, manageable experiences. Evidence of inheritance therefore cannot establish that change is impossible, or tell us exactly how one individual will behave.

[3] Environmental explanations emphasise family relationships, school experiences and cultural expectations. A classroom that allows pupils to make mistakes safely may encourage participation, whereas constant ridicule may discourage it. Nevertheless, the same environment does not affect everyone identically. One pupil may interpret a difficult task as an exciting opportunity; another may regard it as a threat. Their previous experiences and individual tendencies can shape these interpretations.

[4] The interaction also works in the opposite direction. People help to create the environments they experience. Someone who enjoys conversation may join a debating club, gaining further opportunities to practise speaking. A quieter student may choose an activity that rewards careful observation. These choices can strengthen existing tendencies, although new opportunities may also broaden a person's behaviour. This feedback helps explain why personality can show both continuity and development.

[5] Schools should therefore avoid fixed labels such as “a natural leader” or “not a people person”. Labels may lower expectations and restrict opportunities before students have had a chance to improve. Recognising inherited differences does not require accepting educational limits. Instead, teachers can provide varied activities and supportive feedback, allowing learners to develop strengths and practise less familiar skills. Personality is better understood as a developing pattern than as a finished product.

Choose A, B or C.

1. Which activity is specifically mentioned as providing speaking practice?

A A debating club
B A research voyage
C A coding workshop

2. What do similarities between relatives suggest?

A Every personality trait is fixed
B Some differences may involve inherited influences
C School experiences have no effect

3. Why does the writer discuss manageable experiences?

A To show that initial tendencies can develop
B To argue that confidence is entirely inherited
C To prove that unfamiliar situations are harmful

4. According to the text, a safe classroom may encourage pupils to…

A avoid every challenge
B participate more readily
C ignore cultural expectations

5. How can people strengthen existing tendencies?

A By choosing activities that suit those tendencies
B By receiving identical experiences
C By avoiding all feedback

6. What is the main point of paragraph 3?

A Schools influence everyone in exactly the same way
B Family relationships matter more than every other influence
C Environmental effects depend partly on individual interpretation

7. What can be inferred about offering a quieter pupil a supportive speaking role?

A It is pointless because quietness cannot change
B It may broaden behaviour without denying current tendencies
C It guarantees that the pupil will become a leader

8. Which statement best captures the whole argument?

A Personality reflects an interaction of inheritance and experience
B Genetic explanations should replace educational support
C People should only practise their strongest skills

Reading 3B (8 × 2 = 16 marks)

Beyond the city-or-town divide

[1] Comparisons between megacities and small towns often begin with a familiar contrast: the city offers opportunity, while the town offers tranquillity. This distinction is appealing because it turns a complicated decision into a simple choice. Yet settlement size alone is a poor guide to everyday experience. Access to employment, reliable services and social networks matters as much as the number of people sharing a place.

[2] Large cities can concentrate universities, hospitals and specialised employers within a relatively small geographical area. In principle, this concentration allows residents to reach more opportunities without travelling between regions. In practice, however, proximity does not guarantee accessibility. Expensive housing can push workers towards distant districts, while

congested or poorly connected transport routes make apparently short journeys exhausting. The benefits of urban concentration are therefore distributed unevenly.

[3] Small towns present a different combination of possibilities and constraints. Local journeys may be shorter, and familiar neighbours can provide informal support. Nevertheless, specialist treatment or advanced training may require travel to a larger centre. Digital services can reduce some disadvantages: remote consultations and online courses extend access without eliminating distance entirely. A screen cannot replace every medical examination, and an unreliable connection can turn a promised opportunity into another barrier.

[4] Environmental comparisons are similarly conditional. Dense neighbourhoods can support efficient public transport because many passengers live near the same routes. A small town with scattered housing may generate more car travel per resident, despite having cleaner-looking streets. Conversely, poorly planned urban development can remove vegetation and intensify heat. Neither density nor open space is automatically sustainable; outcomes depend on infrastructure, building design and residents' practical choices.

[5] The most useful question is therefore not which type of settlement is universally superior, but which arrangements allow different people to live well. A student, a parent and an older resident may value the same place differently. Planners who listen to these varied needs can improve connections between towns and cities rather than forcing them into competition. A settlement succeeds when its advantages are accessible, its limitations are acknowledged, and public investment responds to the people who actually live there.

Choose A, B or C.

1. What may force workers to live farther from city opportunities?

A Expensive housing
B Too many online courses
C A lack of neighbouring towns

2. What limitation of digital medical services is mentioned?

A They always cost more than hospital visits
B They cannot replace every physical examination
C They are available only in megacities

3. Why can dense neighbourhoods support public transport?

A They remove the need for infrastructure
B They guarantee free transport
C Many passengers live near the same routes

4. What can be inferred from the distinction between proximity and accessibility?

A Nearby services may still be difficult to use
B All city services are equally accessible
C Distance is the only factor that matters

5. What would the writer probably infer about a town with scattered housing and weak bus services?

A Its open space guarantees sustainability
B Residents may rely heavily on cars
C It will have no environmental impact

6. Which description best matches the tone?

- **A** Nostalgic and dismissive
- **B** Angry and accusatory
- **C** Measured and analytical

7. How are the transport and digital-service examples connected?

- **A** Both show that potential benefits depend on enabling systems
- **B** Both prove that technology removes every disadvantage
- **C** Both show that cities should compete against towns

8. Which statement best expresses the overall meaning?

- **A** Megacities are always better for all residents
- **B** Small towns should avoid investment
- **C** Quality of life depends on accessible systems and different needs

Writing (40 marks)

Task 1.1: Comparing places (15 marks)

> Some people believe that a large city is the best place for young adults to begin independent life. They value the range of universities, employers and cultural activities available within one area. Public transport can also allow people to travel without owning a car, especially when they live near reliable routes. Supporters acknowledge that housing may be expensive and crowded streets can be tiring. However, they argue that the chance to gain qualifications, meet people from different backgrounds and try different careers makes these difficulties worthwhile. For them, access to opportunity is the most important consideration when choosing a home.
>
> Others argue that a small town offers a better starting point. They value quieter surroundings, familiar neighbours and housing that may be more affordable. A supportive community can make independent living feel less overwhelming, while shorter local journeys may leave more time for family and interests. Supporters accept that specialist courses and jobs may be limited, and some residents must travel elsewhere. Nevertheless, they believe that online learning and flexible work can reduce these disadvantages. In their view, a manageable daily routine and a sense of belonging are more valuable than having the widest possible range of opportunities nearby.

Question: Compare and contrast the two points of view. Summarise the main ideas in your own words. Write 4–5 sentences.

Task 1.2: Comparative essay (25 marks)

Compare living in a large city with living in a small town for a family with school-age children. In your essay:

- compare access to education and everyday services;
- explain which setting you think is more suitable and give reasons;

- support your choice with examples, acknowledging one advantage of the other setting.

Write at least 220 words in paragraphs.

Planning: position → two comparison points → reasons and examples → balanced conclusion.

Write your essay on the next page.

Essay

Word count: _____

8 Final checklist

Vocabulary

☐ I can explain and use all the Part 1 words.

☐ I can tell apart distractions/interruptions and voyage/destination.

☐ I understand every green-roof term and common word combinations.

Grammar

☐ Zero conditional: if + present simple, present simple.

☐ Comparatives: cooler; more effective; better; worse.

☐ Quantity and degree: much cooler; slightly higher; less water; fewer plants.

☐ Present simple passive: is/are + past participle.

☐ Indirect questions: where it goes; whether it is safe.

☐ Linkers: addition, contrast and result.

☐ Sequencing: first, next, then, finally.

Reading

☐ I can support each reading answer with evidence.

☐ I can distinguish details, main points and overall meaning.

☐ I can infer carefully and recognise a qualified, analytical tone.

☐ I can explain connections between examples and wider ideas.

Writing

☐ I can summarise two viewpoints in 4–5 original sentences.

☐ I can write a comparative essay of at least 220 words, with reasons and examples.

☐ I have prepared both themes: smart homes and comparing places.

Essay self-check

☐ I answered all three prompts.

☐ My introduction names both options and gives a clear position.

☐ Each body paragraph compares the same feature in both places.

☐ I gave reasons and at least one realistic example.

☐ I acknowledged one advantage of the other option.

☐ I used comparison linkers (whereas, however, both, unlike…).

☐ My conclusion confirms my judgement.

☐ I wrote at least 220 words in paragraphs.

☐ I checked verbs, spelling and punctuation.

9 Answer key

Matching 1

1 l (privacy)
2 i (freedom)
3 j (automation)
4 g (cost-effective)
5 d (interruptions)
6 h (distractions)
7 e (voyage)
8 c (destination)
9 f (heritable)
10 b (significant)
11 k (consequence)
12 a (database)

Matching 2

1 f (megacity)
2 d (urbanisation)
3 j (congestion)
4 i (pollution)
5 g (infrastructure)
6 h (innovative)
7 b (kinaesthetic)
8 l (auditory)
9 k (insulation)
10 c (drainage)
11 e (biodiversity)
12 a (vegetation)

Sentence gap-fill

1 C – **innovative**: Introducing new ideas or methods.
2 A – **automation**: Using machines or software to perform tasks automatically.
3 A – **urbanisation**: The growth of towns and cities as more people live there.
4 A – **interruptions**: Events that stop an activity for a short time.
5 B – **auditory**: Connected with hearing or sound.
6 B – **drainage**: A system or process that removes excess water.
7 C – **database**: An organised electronic collection of information.
8 B – **kinaesthetic**: Connected with movement and physical activity.
9 A – **vegetation**: Plants growing in a particular area.
10 A – **insulation**: Material that reduces the transfer of heat or sound.
11 C – **voyage**: A long journey, especially by sea or through space.
12 A – **significant**: Important or large enough to have an effect.
13 B – **pollution**: Harmful substances or waste in the environment.
14 B – **freedom**: The ability or right to make your own choices.
15 B – **congestion**: Overcrowding, especially too much traffic.
16 A – **biodiversity**: The variety of living organisms in an area.
17 B – **heritable**: Able to be passed from parents to offspring through genes.
18 B – **infrastructure**: Basic systems such as roads, power, water and transport.
19 B – **destination**: The place to which someone is travelling.
20 C – **megacity**: A city with a population of more than ten million.
21 B – **privacy**: Keeping personal information and activities protected.
22 B – **distractions**: Things that draw your attention away from your task.
23 A – **consequence**: A result or effect of an action or situation.
24 A – **cost-effective**: Giving good results for the money spent.

Choose the best word

1 B – A voyage is a journey.
2 A – Drainage removes excess water.
3 C – Heritable means passed through genes.
4 A – Congestion means overcrowded traffic.
5 B – Cost-effective balances cost and results.
6 B – Biodiversity is the variety of living organisms.

Collocations

1 A – *Traffic congestion* means too many vehicles on the road.

2 A – *Air pollution* means harmful substances in the air.

3 C – *Urban infrastructure* means a city's roads, power, water and transport.

4 B – You *protect your privacy*.

5 A – Native plants *support biodiversity*.

6 B – Engineers *improve drainage* to stop flooding.

7 C – *A significant consequence* is an important result.

8 B – Students *avoid distractions* when they study.

9 C – *A space voyage* is a long journey through space.

10 A – *A holiday destination* is a place people visit on holiday.

11 A – *Roof insulation* keeps heat out or in.

12 A – *Home automation* means smart devices controlling tasks at home.

13 B – *Rapid urbanisation* means cities growing very fast.

14 C – *An online database* stores information electronically.

Confusing pairs

1 A – It **stopped** the activity, so it was an interruption.

2 B – It pulls your attention away but doesn't stop you, so it is a distraction.

3 A – The journey itself is the voyage.

4 B – The place you reach is the destination.

5 A – Freedom is the right to make your own choices.

6 B – Privacy is keeping personal information protected.

7 B – Fumes are harmful substances, so this is pollution.

8 A – Too much traffic is congestion.

9 A – Vegetation means the plants growing in an area.

10 B – Biodiversity is the variety of living things.

11 A – Insulation reduces heat and sound transfer.

12 B – Drainage removes excess water.

13 A – Auditory = connected with hearing.

14 B – Kinaesthetic = connected with movement.

15 A – A megacity is a single city of more than ten million people.

16 B – Urbanisation is the process of urban growth.

Word forms

1 A – After *that* we need a verb: **pollute**.

2 B – After *to* we need a base verb: **automate**.

3 C – After *highly* we need an adjective/participle: **urbanised**.

4 A – An adjective describes the noun *designs*: **innovative**.

5 B – After *a real* we need a noun: **innovation**.

6 B – After *the* we need a noun: **significance**.

7 C – An adverb describes the verb *have risen*: **significantly**.

8 B – After *is always* we need an adjective: **congested**.

9 A – Passive/adjective after *well*: **insulated**.

10 B – Present simple with a singular subject: **drains**.

11 C – An adverb describes *speak*: **privately**.

12 A – We need a verb: **inherit**.

13 B – A linking adverb at the start of a sentence: **Consequently**.

14 B – After *be* we need an adjective: **free**.

Spelling puzzle

1 congestion

2 innovative

3 kinaesthetic

4 biodiversity

5 destination

6 vegetation

7 megacity

8 pollution

9 urbanisation

10 database

11 automation

12 heritable

Exam-style text 1: A voyage to Mars

1 B – *A long voyage … a journey*: voyage = the journey.

2 A – Information is stored in a **database**.

3 C – Sharing a small space means little **privacy**.

4 A – Alarms *stop* work and sleep, so they are **interruptions**.

5 B – Machines doing tasks automatically = **automation**.

Exam-style text 2: Growing cities

1 B – More people living in cities = **urbanisation**.

2 A – Cairo and Mumbai have more than ten million people: **megacity**.

3 C – **Traffic congestion** makes journeys slow.

4 B – New ideas such as driverless buses are **innovative**.

5 A – Roads, power lines and pipes = **infrastructure**.

Exam-style text 3: Learning by doing

1 B – Listening = **auditory**.

2 A – Moving and using your hands = **kinaesthetic**.

3 B – *No significant benefit* = no important effect.

4 C – *Passed down from parents* = **heritable**.

5 A – A result of an action = **consequence**.

Use the words (model answers)

1 A voyage is the long journey itself, whereas a destination is the place you reach at the end of it.

2 Automation is convenient, but households should protect their privacy.

3 Roof insulation can reduce the effect of urban heat inside a building.

4 Rooftop vegetation can provide a habitat for insects and birds.

5 In a megacity, traffic congestion can make short journeys very slow.

6 One significant consequence of urbanisation is higher demand for housing.

Practice: Zero conditional

1 A – Present simple result in a zero conditional.

2 B – *Falls* agrees with *rain*.

3 B – *Receive* agrees with *they*.

4 A – General fact: present simple in both clauses.

5 B – Singular subject *the temperature* → **drops**.

6 A – Plural *plants* → **don't get**.

7 A – *You* + base form **heat**.

8 B – Plural *people* → **sleep**.

9 A – Plural *rooms* → **become**.

10 A – Present simple + present simple, with correct agreement.

11 B – Put a comma after the if-clause when it comes first.

Practice: Comparative adjectives

1 C – *Cooler* compares two surfaces.

2 A – Long adjective → *more* + adjective.

3 C – *Better* is the irregular comparative of *good*.

4 B – Short adjective + **-er**.

5 A – Long adjective → **more expensive**.

6 A – Irregular: bad → **worse**.

7 B – Consonant + y → **-ier**: heavier.

8 B – **Quieter**; never use *more* and *-er* together.

9 A – **Less** + adjective + *than* = a lower degree.

10 B – Equality: **as** … **as**.

11 B – One vowel + one consonant → double it: **hotter**.

Practice: Adverbs of quantity and degree

1 B – *Much* modifies a comparative.

2 C – *Less* + uncountable *water*.

3 C – *Fewer* + countable plural *weeds*.

4 B – **Much** + comparative.

5 B – *Hospitals* is countable plural → **fewer**.

6 A – **Enough** = the amount needed.

7 A – A small difference → **slightly**.

8 A – Uncountable *water* → **too much**.

9 A – **Considerably** + comparative = a big difference.

10 B – Countable plural *people* → **Many**.

11 A – **Far** + comparative = much.

Practice: Present simple passive

1 B – Plural *plants* + *are* + past participle.

2 A – Uncountable *rainwater* + *is stored*.

3 B – Singular *material* + *is* + *chosen*.

4 B – Singular subject + **is spoken**.

5 B – Plural *panels* → **are cleaned**.

6 B – *by farmers* shows the passive: **is grown**.

7 A – Uncountable *information* → **is stored**.

8 A – *is* + past participle **designed**.

9 A – Negative passive: **is not** + past participle.

10 B – Plural *plants* → **Are** … checked?

11 B – Plural subject + **are made**.

Practice: Indirect questions

1 B – Statement word order: subject + verb.

2 A – *If* introduces a yes/no question.

3 B – Statement word order after the introduction.

4 A – Statement order: *the station* **is**.

5 B – Remove *does*; add **-s** to the verb.

6 A – Yes/no question → **if**.

7 A – Statement order: the journey **takes**.

8 A – No *do* in an indirect question: **where they live**.

9 B – Remove *did* and use the past form: **left**.

10 B – **if** + subject + verb.

11 A – Statement order + **costs**.

Practice: Adverbial linkers

1 C – *However* shows the contrast between cost and savings.

2 A – *Consequently* gives the result.

3 A – Positive → negative = contrast: **However**.

4 B – Another positive point = addition: **Furthermore**.

5 A – Cause → effect: **As a result**.

6 A – Unexpected result = contrast: **Nevertheless**.

7 A – Another benefit = addition: **In addition**.

8 B – Full stop before *However*, comma after it.

9 B – **therefore** = result.

10 A – **furthermore** = addition.

Practice: Sequencing adverbs

1 B – *Next* gives the second stage.

2 A – The beginning → **First**.

3 A – The following stage → **Then**.

4 A – The last stage → **Finally**.

5 C – **finally** = the last stage.

6 B – **however** shows contrast, not order.

7 A – Later stage → **Afterwards**.

Spot the correct sentence

1 A – *much* + comparative; never *more cooler* or *very cooler*.
2 A – Indirect question → statement word order.
3 B – Plural subject + *are* + past participle.
4 B – Zero conditional: present + present.
5 A – Countable plural → *fewer*.
6 C – Full stop + *However* + comma.
7 B – good → *better*.
8 B – *if* + subject + verb.
9 C – Plural → *are cleaned*.
10 B – Long adjective → *more stressful than*.
11 A – Zero conditional with correct agreement.
12 C – First → Then → Finally.

Name the linker

1 A (moreover)
2 C (however)
3 R (therefore)
4 S (first)
5 C (nevertheless)
6 R (consequently)
7 A (in addition)
8 S (finally)
9 R (as a result)
10 A (furthermore)
11 S (next)
12 S (afterwards)

Put the steps in order A

1, 2, 3, 4, 5 (top to bottom)

Put the steps in order B

4, 2, 5, 1, 3 (top to bottom)

Rewrite the sentence

1 The roof is checked (by workers) every month.
2 The plants are watered (by gardeners) twice a week.
3 A light material is chosen for the roof (by engineers).
4 Rainwater is stored in the tank.
5 Could you tell me where the rainwater goes?
6 Do you know if / whether the roof is strong enough?
7 Can you explain how much a living roof costs?
8 Do you know when they installed the panels?
9 If plants get enough sunlight, they grow quickly.
10 A living roof is cooler than a bare roof.

Grammar text 1: Cool roofs

1 A – Zero conditional: *If a surface* **is** dark (present simple, singular).
2 A – Present simple passive, singular *which* (= the roof): **is painted**.
3 B – **much** + comparative *cooler*.
4 A – A cooler roof → less air conditioning = result: **As a result**.
5 A – Indirect question, statement order: *the coating* **costs**.

Grammar text 2: Collecting rainwater

1 A – The first stage of the process: **First** (followed by *Then*).
2 A – Passive, uncountable *water*: **is stored**.
3 A – Zero conditional, singular *tank*: **becomes**.
4 A – **less** + adjective + *than*.
5 A – Indirect yes/no question: *whether the system* **needs**.

Signal words for tone and inference

1 A – *Unevenly* = some people benefit more than others.
2 B – *In principle … in practice* contrasts theory with reality.
3 A – Hedging language shows a measured, qualified view.
4 B – Balanced evidence + qualifications = **measured and analytical**.
5 B – The writer accepts inheritance but says behaviour can develop.
6 A – Absolute words like *always* and *guarantees* often go beyond the text.
7 B – *Conversely* = looking at it from the opposite side.
8 A – Overall meaning must cover the whole text.

Paraphrase practice

1 B – A good paraphrase keeps the meaning (including *often*) but changes the words.
2 C – Same meaning, new words; the third option exaggerates.
3 B – Keeps *can* as *may*; doesn't exaggerate.
4 C – Changes vocabulary and structure, but the meaning stays.
5 A – Accurate and in new words.
6 C – Good paraphrase: new words, same idea.

Comparison linkers in context

1 A – Two contrasting ideas in one sentence → **Whereas**.
2 A – A similarity → **Both**.
3 A – **Unlike** + noun shows contrast.
4 A – Both have health services → similarity.
5 A – A contrasting point → **On the other hand**.
6 A – A final judgement → **On balance**.
7 A – A reason → **because**.
8 A – A concession → **Although**.

Mock Part 1: Vocabulary

1 B – Traffic congestion explains queues.
2 A – A database stores information for comparison.
3 C – Vegetation refers to rooftop plants.
4 B – Different living organisms indicate biodiversity.
5 C – Comparing costs identifies a cost-effective option.

Mock Part 2: Grammar

1 A – Singular *structure* + present passive: **is checked**.
2 B – Zero conditional: *if rain* **falls**.
3 C – **much cooler** is a correctly modified comparative.
4 B – Indirect question, statement order: **works**.
5 A – **However** contrasts the high cost with the benefits.

Mock Reading 3A

1 A – **Specific information.** Paragraph 4 names a debating club.

2 B – **Detail.** Paragraph 2: a heritable component, not that every trait is fixed.

3 A – **Detail.** Paragraph 2: someone may gain confidence through manageable experiences.

4 B – **Detail.** Paragraph 3 links making mistakes safely with participation.

5 A – **Detail.** Paragraph 4: people choose environments that suit them.

6 C – **Main point.** The same environment is interpreted differently.

7 B – **Inference.** Paragraphs 4–5 support broadening behaviour; nothing is guaranteed.

8 A – **Overall meaning.** The opening and closing present personality as an interaction.

Mock Reading 3B

1 A – **Detail.** Paragraph 2: expensive housing pushes workers to distant districts.

2 B – **Detail.** Paragraph 3: a screen cannot replace every examination.

3 C – **Detail.** Paragraph 4.

4 A – **Inference.** Cost and connections matter as well as distance.

5 B – **Inference.** Scattered housing → more car travel.

6 C – **Tone.** Qualified, balanced language.

7 A – **Connections.** A possible advantage depends on infrastructure or reliable connections.

8 C – **Overall meaning.** No universal winner; access and needs matter.

Model answers

Smart homes

Both viewpoints consider whether connected technology improves life at home. Supporters emphasise easier daily routines, potential energy savings and greater independence for some residents. Critics focus on data protection, ongoing expenses and difficulties when technology fails. Both recognise that devices can be useful when they are selected carefully. Their main difference is that supporters prioritise the benefits of automation, whereas critics emphasise caution and reliable manual alternatives.

Smart homes

Choosing between a highly automated home and a mainly conventional home involves more than deciding how many devices to buy. Both can be comfortable, but they differ in convenience, running costs and the amount of control residents keep over their daily routines. In my view, a mainly conventional home with a few carefully selected smart features offers the best balance.

Automation can make ordinary tasks easier. For example, lights that switch off in empty rooms remove the need to check every room before leaving. Voice controls may also help someone who finds physical switches difficult to reach. By contrast, conventional controls require more direct action, although their familiar design can make them easier for visitors and less confident users to understand.

Costs also deserve careful comparison. A smart cooling system may reduce wasted electricity by responding to household routines. However, the initial price, possible subscriptions and future repairs can reduce those savings. A conventional home may be cheaper to maintain, particularly when residents already use energy carefully. The better option therefore depends on actual needs rather than impressive advertising.

I would choose limited automation because it provides useful support without making every activity depend on a connected system. For instance, I would install efficient lighting controls but keep ordinary switches available. I would also check privacy settings before adding any device that collects personal information.

Overall, smart homes offer valuable conveniences, while conventional homes provide simplicity and predictable control. Combining a reliable basic design with selected technology is, for me, a practical and affordable way to enjoy the advantages of both.

Why this works: it compares the same features, answers all three prompts, states a clear preference and supports it with examples. Learn from its structure; don't memorise it.

Comparing places

Both viewpoints discuss where young adults can build a satisfying independent life. The city supporters prioritise access to education, employment, transport and varied social experiences. Those who favour small towns emphasise affordable living, community support and a calmer routine. Each side accepts that its preferred setting has limitations, including urban costs or fewer local opportunities. The central contrast is between choosing a wider range of opportunities and choosing a more manageable lifestyle with a stronger sense of belonging.

Comparing places

Families with school-age children need a place that supports learning and makes everyday life manageable. Large cities and small towns can both meet these needs, although they offer different advantages. I would generally choose a well-connected small town, provided that it has reliable schools and basic services.

Large cities usually offer a wider choice of schools, libraries and specialist activities. A child who enjoys science, for example, may have access to museums and organised workshops. Specialist medical care may also be easier to find. However, availability does not always mean convenient access: high costs and long journeys can prevent families from using these opportunities regularly.

Small towns may have fewer institutions, but shorter local journeys can make school routines simpler. Parents may spend less time travelling and more time helping with homework or joining community activities. A family that lives near its school and a local clinic could find this arrangement very practical. Nevertheless, it might need to travel to a city for specialist treatment or an unusual course.

My preference is based on the value of a manageable daily routine. If children have a suitable school, safe recreation spaces and supportive neighbours, they do not necessarily need every possible activity nearby. For example, a local sports club can provide regular friendships and exercise, while occasional city visits can offer additional experiences.

Overall, cities provide variety and specialist services, whereas small towns can offer convenience and close community ties. The best choice depends on the actual services available. For my family, a connected small town would combine everyday stability with access to wider opportunities when necessary.

A different preference can also succeed if it answers every prompt with clear comparisons, reasons and examples.